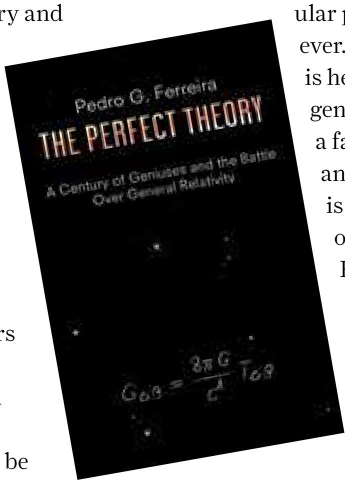
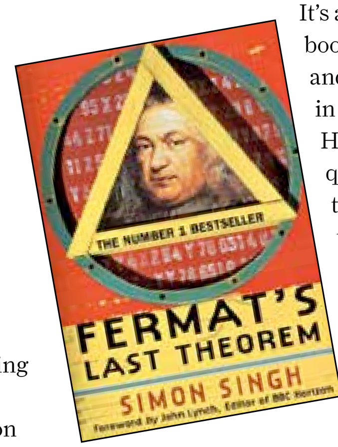
Einstein's theory of general relativity. Considering that the subject matter is difficult to explain and has been written about plenty of times before, there's a certain novelty to Ferreira's approach. He talks about the events that led to the development of the theory and describes, sometimes in detail, the great personalities that pioneered its use. The book also dives into the implications of the theory, which are grand to say the least. Einstein's field equations helped scientists discover the very fabric of the universe, the lives of stars and stellar objects and the mysteries of black holes and other singularities in space-time. While this book might be a bit too heavy for the general reader, it's practically gold dust for anyone who has ever wondered why the theory of general relativity is the most revered theory in the history of physics.

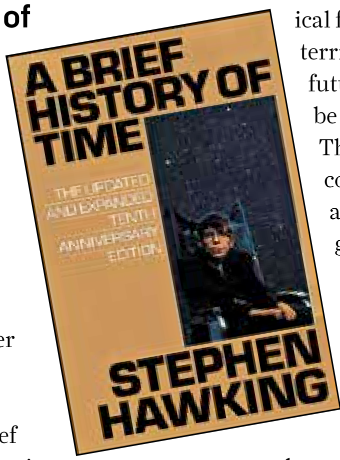


4 Fermat's Last Theorem by Simone Singh



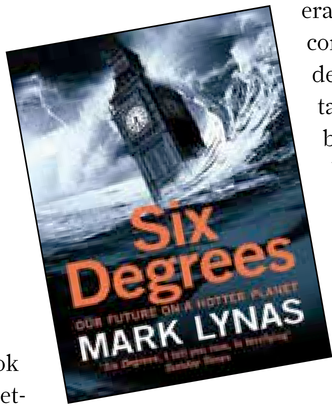
Based on a theorem in number theory that was unproven for more than 350 years, 'Fermat's Last Theorem' is a story of one man's obsession with proving it. Simone Singh excels at telling the story of Princeton mathematician Andrew Wiles, who struggled for close to six years to solve a long standing problem in mathematics. We're sucked into Wiles' tumultuous journey full of ups and downs as he finds a chink in his proof and then proceeds to finally correct it. The book is gripping and never loses pace, which is surprising since it's based on a theorem in pure mathematics. While the title may dissuade most readers from picking up this book, we strongly recommend it. It's a gripping story told with the right amount of detail and an almost infectious enthusiasm.

5 A Brief History of Time by Stephen Hawking



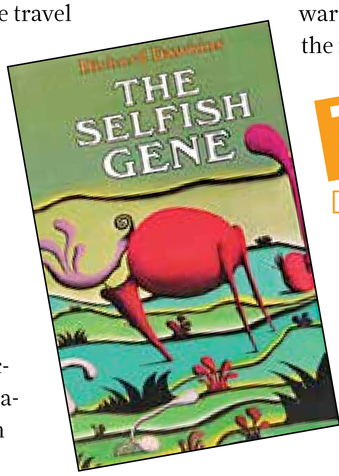
Stephen Hawking is hands down one of the most popular physicists ever. Not only is he a brilliant genius, he's also a fantastic writer and this book is an example of both. 'A Brief History of Time' paints a large canvas of the cosmos of which the earth is just the tiniest fragment. Discussing the possibilities of time travel and existence of wormholes, Hawking touches upon topics bordering on meta, such as the beginning of time itself. It's a wonderful book, short, crisp and powerful in its own right. Hawking frequently uses pictorial representations to explain complicated concepts such as particle spin and almost no equations. He writes with flair and brings in his traditional British humour and excellent scientific insight, making it a satisfying read.

6 Six Degrees: Our Future on a Hotter Planet by Mark Lynas



The IPCC (International Panel on Climate Change has claimed that Earth's global temperature could rise by upto 6 degree Celsius at the end of the century. Lynas' book deals with mankind's hypothetical future on Earth. What's terrifying though is that the future he describes may not be hypothetical after all. The landmark Copenhagen conference set the tolerable limit for the rise in global temperature to close to 2 degree Celsius. At that tipping point, some countries would flat out disappear. In an almost countdown-like fashion, Lynas breaks down the effects of global temperature rise degree by degree. He sieves through scientific evidence including research papers, investigative reports and computer simulations to present a clear and concise account of how global warming can literally change the face of Earth.

7 The Selfish Gene by Richard Dawkins



'The Selfish Gene' has influenced many debates and shaped scientific pop culture by introducing revolutionary ideas – relevant even today, almost thirty years after first being published. Among other things, Dawkins, in the book, coined the term 'meme' to describe a unit of human cultural evolution that encompasses all of human culture, fashion and fads and quite analogously like a gene is selected and passed from one generation to another. Without concentrating on scientific details of genes, Dawkins talks about the role played by genes in evolution. Using an approach frequently referred to as 'reductionist', Dawkins presents the idea that genes control the future by controlling information transfer and that organism exist simply